

Chapter 157-4

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Those three words "I don't know" truly encompassed far too much.

Zhao Xuning had been in this state ever since she broke up with Shen Hui.

During the time when she was dating Shen Hui, whenever anyone asked her what she wanted, she could clearly and decisively articulate her needs.

But now, the moment she heard this question, she would subconsciously start to avoid it.

Because she didn't dare say what she wanted.

Because those desires had become extravagant hopes.

Things that had once been within reach.

Zhao Xuning drove all the way home. She called a colleague downstairs to swap shifts, and only when she entered and saw an unfamiliar pair of shoes did she remember there was someone else in the house.

Liang Shi actually had somewhere to go.

The keys to the apartment that Liang Xinzhou had given her before were in her hands, and she could move there anytime.

But she hadn't gone there, instead coming to Zhao Xuning's place.

Perhaps during these difficult days, she didn't want to be alone.

Zhao Xuning turned on the projector, put on her VR headset, and started watching a movie.

She was also used to the pace of living alone and didn't change just because there was one more person in the house.

As for Liang Shi, she slept until evening, and only opened the door to the guest room when the sky was filled with rosy clouds.

For a modern person, being without a phone felt like something was missing.

After waking up, Liang Shi also instinctively reached for her phone. Only after grabbing a phone with a black screen did she realize she had moved out and had turned off her phone.

As she sat on the bed in a daze, the orange-pink clouds spread across the horizon, and the remaining light fell through and sprinkled on her. She raised her hand to shield her eyes and actually felt a few drops of water.

Liang Shi sniffled, pulled a tissue from the bedside, and wiped the moisture from her hand.

Then she got up lazily, went out, and upon pushing open the door saw Zhao Xuning absorbed in watching a movie. She walked over and sat down familiarly. "Dr. Zhao, are you hungry?"

Zhao Xuning took off her glasses and earphones. "What?"

"What are we eating tonight?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Xuning shrugged: "I do intermittent fasting at night. I don't eat."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Didn't you drink with me before?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Xuning: "That was an exception."

Cold voice, cold demeanor, mechanical like an AI.

Liang Shi was silent for a moment. "Let's have spicy crayfish¹, the most numbing and spiciest kind."

Zhao Xuning frowned and looked at her, as if asking—aren't you someone who can't handle spicy food?

But Liang Shi nodded to herself. She instinctively went to order delivery, only to find that her phone was off. She looked at Zhao Xuning: "Dr. Zhao, you order it."

Zhao Xuning: "?"

While ordering the delivery, Zhao Xuning asked: "Between you and Xu Qingzhu, who brought it up?"

Liang Shi was startled, pausing for a moment before reacting. She leaned her head over to Zhao Xuning's side to look at the screen. "I did."

Zhao Xuning nodded: "Alright."

She went ahead and ordered the most numbing and spiciest kind.

"Then what about Xu Qingzhu?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Liang Shi: "...At home, or at the company. I don't know."

She was very calm, so calm that she didn't seem like someone who had just gotten divorced.

But it might also be because she was the one who initiated the divorce, so she felt more at ease.

However, her eyes were more swollen than when she'd seen her this morning, so she wasn't completely indifferent.

Zhao Xuning glanced at her, put her phone aside, and let her gaze fall back on the big screen.

She clicked play, and Liang Shi said in surprise: "I really like this one too."

Zhao Xuning nodded: "This one is pretty obscure."

Liang Shi shrugged: "But it's really good."

Zhao Xuning didn't speak again after that. She was a person of few words, especially today after going home and being in a bad mood. She just wanted to watch movies to dispel the frustration in her heart.

As for Liang Shi, normally—at least in front of Xiao Bai and Sister Wang before—she was pathetically quiet. But now compared to Zhao Xuning, she was actually the talkative one.

Though not by much. Occasionally during exciting parts of the movie, she would comment that the cinematography was really good, or that this frame was really beautiful.

In less than half an hour, the crayfish was delivered.

There was still beer in the fridge that Liang Shi had bought this morning, so the two of them sat by the coffee table and started eating.

Liang Shi really couldn't handle spicy food. If it were the original owner's body from before, she could have tolerated it a little, but her own body would be brought to tears by the spiciness.

Zhao Xuning was slightly better than her, but not by much.

By the time they finished eating, their noses and eyes were redder than the crayfish on the table.

Liang Shi looked at Zhao Xuning through the watery haze, and then Zhao Xuning opened two bottles of her treasured red wine.

After drinking too much, Liang Shi said indignantly: "How can there be people who are 100% compatible?! Why do I have to get divorced?! I finally had a home... and just like that, it's falling apart."

"At least you got married." Zhao Xuning was also a bit tipsy. "I didn't even get to marry."

Liang Shi glanced at her: "Then go get married!"

Zhao Xuning: "...Shut up!"

"You stubborn ghost." Liang Shi said.

Zhao Xuning: "...Like you're any better?"

The retort was filled with thick sarcasm.

Liang Shi froze, then raised her glass to change the subject: "Come on, come on, let's drink."

The topic was thus brushed aside.

But after a few more glasses of wine, Zhao Xuning leaned against the sofa and rambled: "What's wrong with Xu Qingzhu? Did you two fight before the divorce? She came to me a few days ago to get sleep medication."

Hearing this, Liang Shi felt a dull ache in her heart, as if something had struck her. "It should be fine after this."

As long as she left, as long as they divorced, everything would be fine.

"Then why does it feel like you're not sad at all?" Zhao Xuning asked. "Didn't you used to love Xu Qingzhu to death?"

Liang Shi: "..."

After a long while, Liang Shi said quietly: "We haven't really divorced yet."

In the future... she would still win her back.

These words puzzled Zhao Xuning, but Liang Shi refused to say any more no matter what.

She didn't dare have even a hint of such thoughts, afraid they would be detected.

She couldn't have thoughts about exploiting bugs in the world's rules for even a second.

So all of this was real. She really was going to divorce Xu Qingzhu, following the development of the plot line.

She was leaving this time and space for Xu Qingzhu and Lu Jiayi, this pair of Soulmates.

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1. "麻小" (má xiǎo) is short for "麻辣小龙虾" (málà xiǎolóngxiā), meaning "numbing spicy crayfish." It's a popular Chinese dish featuring crayfish cooked in a sauce with Sichuan peppercorns (which create a numbing sensation) and chili peppers. It's a beloved late-night snack and drinking food in China. ↩